



The Impact Loop Standard

Turn frontline impact into fundable, defensible data

A documented methodology for converting the growth your team sees every day into longitudinal, auditable impact data — the kind funders trust, and competitors can't copy.

WHY THIS EXISTS

"We can see they've grown" no longer wins grants.

Funders want outcomes, not activity. But the growth a frontline worker sees every day lives in memory and scattered notes — and by reporting season it has collapsed into one unprovable sentence. The Impact Loop Standard fixes exactly that, without adding an hour of paperwork to an already-stretched team. It takes about fifteen seconds per observation.

THE CORE UNIT

Everything is built from one Pillar Moment

who • which pillar • how strong (1-5) • growth indicator • direction • short note • timestamp

Staff log it in three taps and a voice note. The note is the human story; the structured tags make it measurable. Thousands of these become an organization's impact dataset.

Growth is organized into five development pillars, each with named indicators:



THE ENGINE

A formula we're happy to publish.

Because the formula was never the moat — transparency is the point. Each pillar carries a 0-100 score, computed from the moments logged against it.

$$\text{PillarScore (0-100)} = \text{weighted average of staff ratings (1-5)} \times 20$$

1 Direction weight

Growth moments count fully. Neutral counts half. A setback keeps full weight but its rating drops to 1 — so it pulls the score down. Honest data, not a feel-good meter.

2 Recency weight

A 30-day half-life. A moment from today counts about twice one from a month ago, so a score reflects who the participant is now — not who they were a year ago.

3 Growth Rate

The change in a PillarScore versus the same score one quarter (91 days) earlier — the headline funders care about, reproducible from the raw moments at any time.

WHAT MAKES IT DEFENSIBLE

Built to survive a funder's scrutiny.

Humans rate, the system only weights

Staff assign every rating. The platform categorizes and aggregates — it never invents a score. Every number drills down to dated, named, quotable observations a funder can audit.

Confidence tiers

Each score is labeled Emerging picture (<3 observations), Developing (3–9), or Strong evidence (10+). One great day never masquerades as transformation.

Self-evaluation cross-check

Participants rate themselves each quarter on the same pillars. Where their view and staff's diverge, the gap becomes a coaching conversation — and a second, independent signal.

Numbers and stories, on one page.

The Impact Report pairs the quarter's growth figures with real anonymized observations in staff's own words. Funders get the measurable outcome and the human moment that proves it — exported on demand.

WHY IT'S AN IMPACT LOOP ASSET

Give the formula away. Own the standard.

A formula is copyable; it is not the moat. What compounds — and cannot be copied — is built around it.

A shared standard

A documented way to convert field observations into comparable outcomes — what accounting standards are to finance. Impact Loop owns the language funders learn to ask for.

Longitudinal benchmark data

Years of dated observations across many organizations create norms no newcomer can replicate. The asset compounds while you sleep.

Funder trust

As the methodology is validated and recognized, “measured on the Impact Loop Standard” becomes a credential a grant officer trusts on sight.

System of record

The daily logging habit makes Impact Loop where impact history lives. Switching means abandoning the evidence behind the last three grant reports.

Measure transformation, not just attendance.

Piloting now with Inner City Outreach · Jane & Finch, Toronto

impactloop.ca · [Book a strategy call](#)